

MASON BENNETT

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SUMMARY

M.S. Finance graduate (4.00 GPA) targeting a wealth management / portfolio analyst seat in Dallas–Fort Worth. Built and deployed a portfolio analytics platform implementing mean-variance optimization, CAPM beta/alpha, and risk-contribution analysis, and led valuation work on two live-transaction reconstructions. Nine years of client-facing work in regulated and high-touch environments. Bloomberg Market Concepts certified; FINRA SIE August 2026.

EDUCATION

University of Arkansas, Sam M. Walton College of Business — Fayetteville, AR **May 2026**

Master of Science in Finance | GPA: 4.00 / 4.00

Coursework: Advanced Financial Modeling, Advanced Corporate Finance, Alternative Investments, New Venture (Private Equity), Financial Data Analytics II

University of Arkansas, Sam M. Walton College of Business — Fayetteville, AR **May 2024**

B.S. Business Administration, Business Economics | GPA: 3.62 / 4.00 | Dean's List (5 semesters)

CERTIFICATIONS & LICENSES

Bloomberg Market Concepts — certified April 2026 • **FINRA Securities Industry Essentials (SIE)** — sitting August 2026

EXPERIENCE

Independent Financial Modeling & Analytics — masonjbennett.com | Dallas–Fort Worth, TX **May 2026 – Present**

- Built and deployed a Python/Streamlit portfolio analytics platform: mean-variance optimization, efficient frontier with capital allocation line, CAPM beta/alpha, Sharpe and Sortino ratios, drawdown analysis, and risk-contribution decomposition, with tiered explanations that adapt to the user's level of investment knowledge.
- Built an 11-module financial planning application covering 2026 federal and 50-state tax estimation, budgeting, debt payoff, savings goals, 401(k) match, and retirement projection; author a 300-term finance reference written for a non-specialist reader.

Shollmier Investment Fund — Garrison Financial Institute, Walton College **Jan – May 2026**

Analyst, Information Technology Sector | Fayetteville, AR

- Covered the Information Technology sector for a live \$700K+ student-managed fixed-income portfolio; researched issuers, analyzed relative value, and submitted trade requests to the fund.

Bartender & Server — fine dining, private club, and WinStar World Casino & Resort | TX, OK & AR **2016 – 2025**

- Served affluent and high-net-worth clientele across fine dining, private-club, and casino settings while holding a Chickasaw Nation gaming license; reconciled high-volume cash with 100% accuracy in a regulated, compliance-sensitive environment.
- Worked throughout both degrees to self-fund 100% of tuition while earning Dean's List honors and a 4.00 graduate GPA.

Finance & Economics Tutor — Self-Employed | Fayetteville, AR **2021 – 2024**

- Tutored 10+ University of Arkansas students per semester in finance, economics, and statistics; average 1–2 letter-grade gain.

Event Manager — Venue on Spring Creek | Collinsville, TX **2016 – 2021**

- Directed weekend operations for 75+ events of up to 100+ guests; supervised a four-person staff and managed vendor contracts and budgets.

SELECTED INVESTMENT & VALUATION WORK

HCA Healthcare (NYSE: HCA) — Equity Pitch, GFI Stock Pitch Competition **October 2025**

- Selected as one of four graduate teams to pitch the GFI Advisory Board of practicing investors; issued a BUY at \$466.58 with a \$557 one-year price target and defended it in live Q&A.
- Triangulated EPS multiple (\$428–\$537), DCF exit multiple (\$497–\$737), and Gordon growth (\$555–\$602) with a 5.8%–7.8% discount-rate sensitivity against THC, UHS, and CYH.

Electronic Arts (NASDAQ: EA) — \$55B Take-Private Valuation | student reconstruction **April 2026**

- Led a four-person graduate deal team valuing Electronic Arts ahead of its take-private; built a 12-tab model, 35-page memorandum, and a five-method football field (DCF, comparable companies, precedent transactions, future share price, premia paid).
- Underwrote a \$36.4B equity / \$18.0B debt structure against \$54.0B implied enterprise value; the deal closed in August 2026 at ~\$36B equity — inclusive of PIF's rolled-over stake — and \$20B of committed debt.

Jagex Limited — £900M / \$1.1B Sponsor-to-Sponsor LBO | student reconstruction **April 2026**

- Led a three-person graduate deal team valuing a £900M / \$1.1B cross-border secondary buyout; built a 10-tab model, 27-page memorandum, a ~10% CAPM-derived WACC, and a three-method football field.
- Analyzed subscription pricing power and recurring-revenue retention as the core drivers of the thesis; normalized \$56.4M reported EBITDA to a \$75M pro-forma basis through \$18.6M of add-backs.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Portfolio Construction & Investment Analysis: Mean-variance optimization, asset allocation, efficient frontier and capital allocation line, CAPM beta/alpha, Sharpe and Sortino ratios, Fama-French and Carhart factor models, risk-contribution decomposition, drawdown and volatility analysis, fixed-income credit research, equity valuation, tax-aware financial planning

Tools: Excel (advanced), PowerPoint, Bloomberg, PitchBook, SEC EDGAR; Python (pandas, NumPy, scipy, Streamlit, Plotly, yfinance), SQL, Stata, R